THE LOST SETTLERS

In 1587, a group of 115 English settlers - men, women and children - sailed from Britain to set up the first English colony in the New World, on Roanoke Island off what is now North Carolina. Two years later, a second expedition set off from England to join them. However, when they arrived, they found the settlement deserted. There were no indications of where the settlers had gone, nor any sign of a struggle, but just one word mysteriously scratched on a tree: "Croatoan". This was the name of a nearby island where the Indians were known to be friendly, but a trip to the island showed that the settlers had never arrived there. One theory is that they travelled inland, up into the hills of Appalachia, and settled there. No one knows why they might have done this, but fifty years later, when European explorers arrived in Tennessee, the Cherokee Indians told them that there was a group of pale people living in the hills already, people who wore clothes and had long beards.

No one ever found this mysterious community. But in a remote and neglected corner of the Appalachians, high up in northeastern Tennessee, there still live some curious people called Melungeons, who have been there for as long as anyone can remember. The Melungeons have most of the characteristics of Europeans - blue eyes, fair hair, lanky build - but a dark, almost Negroid skin coloring that is distinctly non-European. They have English family names, but no one, including the Melungeons themselves, has any idea of where they come from or what their early history might have been. They are as much of a mystery as the lost settlers of Roanoke Island. Indeed, it has been suggested that they may be the lost settlers of Roanoke.

(Adapted from The *Lost Continent* by Bill Bryson)

EXERCISE 1: Find words or phrases in the passage which mean the same as:

	COLUMN A	COLUMN B
a)	establish; start *(phrase)*	
b)	organized journey, with several people, for **a** special reason, e.g., to visit new places, to hunt, etc.	
c)	empty because everyone has left	
d)	signs, clues which give you an idea about something	
e)	make marks on something using something sharp	
f)	away from the sea; towards the middle of a country	
g)	people who travel to a place to find out about it, because they have never been there before	
h)	light in colour, especially for skin	
i)	far from other places and people	
j)	unusual; strange; interesting	
k)	tall and thin, often looking clumsy	
l)	having the physical features of black Africans	
m)	very clearly	

EXERCISE 2: Choose the correct answer according to the passage.

1. The second expedition from England to Roanoke Island.....

A) was lost mysteriously and never found
B) established the first colony there
C) arrived there two years after the first
D) preferred to settle down in Croatoan, where the Indians were friendly
E) joined the first expedition two years later

2. Although it hasn't been proved, ...

A) the first settlers of Roanoke are believed to have been killed by the Indians
B) Melungeons are thought to be descendants of the lost settlers of Roanoke
C) the boat carrying the first expedition might have capsized on her way to the island
D) the Indians living in Croatoan might have concealed something from the searchers
E) the indications of a struggle in the deserted settlement of the first expedition meant they had been attacked

3. No one has definitely been able to say that Melungeons are the lost settlers of Roanoke, because .....

A) there are some other theories about the origins of Melungeons
B) Melungeons themselves claim to be descended from Cherokee Indians, living in Tennessee
C) historians say Melungeons have never settled on Roanoke Island
D) some of the information found out about the mysterious disappearance of the first settlers was confusing
E) there is no information available as to their ancestry

EXERCISE 3: Complete the sentences by selecting words from Column B in EXERCISE 1.

1. The cat viciously.....the man's hand.
2. Bright pink is a very.....colour to paint your living room.
3. You're looking very.....! Are you sure you feel okay?
4. This milk has a.....cheesy flavour. I don't think it's fresh.
5. The kidnappers took their hostage to a.....part of the island.